

How did the wife of a millionaire respond when her husband gave her \$8 million worth of stock in the company he recently took public? According to her husband of thirty-one years, she said, “I appreciate this, I really do.” Then she smiled, never changing her position at the kitchen table, where she continued to cut out twenty-five-and fifty-cents-off food coupons from the week’s supply of newspapers. Nothing is so important as to interrupt her Saturday-morning chores. “She just does today like she always has done, even when all we owned was a kitchen table.... It’s how come we’re well-off today. Made a lot of trade-offs ... sacrifices early in our marriage.”

Why aren’t you wealthy, you ask? Well, let’s examine your lifestyle. Is it one of great offense? Are you in the \$70,000, \$100,000, \$200,000 income category? Congratulations, you play wonderful offense. But how is it that you keep losing the game called wealth accumulation?

Be honest with yourself. Could it be that you play terrible defense? Most high-income earners are in the same situation, but not most millionaires. Millionaires play both quality offense *and* quality defense. And quite often their great defense helps them outscore/outaccumulate those who outearn/have superior offenses. *The foundation stone of wealth accumulation is defense, and this defense should be anchored by budgeting and planning.* We have discovered that several occupational groups contain large numbers of budgeters and planners.

AFFLUENT AUCTIONEERS

Our latest survey of auctioneers found that more than 35 percent of them are millionaires. This percentage is slightly higher than the proportion of millionaire households living in America’s finest urban and suburban neighborhoods.

Auctioneers have been on our list of highly productive types since we conducted our first study of occupations in 1983, when they ranked sixth among those with realized annual incomes of more than \$100,000. But their income alone was not what caught our attention. Given the same level of income, who accumulates more wealth—an auctioneer residing in small-town America or someone who lives in a high-status urban or suburban neighborhood? As you can guess, it is the typical auctioneer.

Auctioneers are more frugal than their high-income-producing counterparts in prestige areas; they have lower overhead both for